

Qroo Paul's Spanish Deep Dive

Lesson 7 Summary

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Welcome to the 7th video in my Deep Dive Series. In this lesson, we're diving into the imperfect subjunctive, which is the subjunctive mood used in the past tense. The good news is that you're already ahead of the curve because it uses the same triggers you've learned for the present subjunctive."

Understanding the Imperfect Subjunctive

- **Example:**
 - *Juan me dijo que fuera a la tienda.* (Juan told me to go to the store.)
 - Here, "fuera" is in the imperfect subjunctive.
 - *Juan me dijo que fuese a la tienda.* is also correct, showing that the imperfect subjunctive has two possible conjugations: the -ra and -se endings.
- **Recommendation:** Focus on the -ra endings, as they are more commonly used in spoken Spanish. For this lesson, we'll only use the -ra form.

Conjugation Overview

- **-AR Verbs:**
 - Yo: -ara
 - Tú: -aras
 - Él/Ella/Usted: -ara
 - Nosotros/Nosotras: -áramos
 - Vosotros/Vosotras: -arais
 - Ellos/Ellas/Ustedes: -aran
- **-ER and -IR Verbs:**
 - Yo: -iera
 - Tú: -ieras
 - Él/Ella/Usted: -iera

- Nosotros/Nosotras: -iéramos
- Vosotros/Vosotras: -ierais
- Ellos/Ellas/Ustedes: -ieran

How to Conjugate:

- Start with the preterite conjugation, drop the endings, and add the imperfect subjunctive endings.
 - **Example with regular verbs:**
 - Hablar: *Yo hablara, tú hablaras, él/ella/usted hablara, nosotros hablaríamos, vosotros hablarais, ellos/ellas/ustedes hablaran.*
 - Beber: *Yo bebiera, tú bebieras, él/ella/usted bebiera, nosotros bebiéramos, vosotros bebierais, ellos/ellas/ustedes bebieran.*
- **Irregular Verbs:**
 - For verbs like *querer, haber, estar, and poder*, use the preterite stem.
 - Ir and ser are truly irregular but share the same conjugation: *Yo fuera, tú fueras, él/ella/usted fuera, nosotros fuéramos, vosotros fuerais, ellos/ellas/ustedes fueran.*

When to Use the Imperfect Subjunctive

- **Subjunctive Triggers:** The triggers remain the same as those you've learned for the present subjunctive.
- **Examples:**
 - *María me dijo que quería que fuera a la tienda antes de que lloviera.* (Maria told me that she wanted me to go to the store before it rained.)
 - *Ella esperaba que los estudiantes tuvieran suficiente tiempo para terminar el proyecto.* (She was hoping that the students had enough time to finish the project.)

Optional Subjunctive Triggers:

- Words like *tal vez, quizá, and quizás* can trigger the subjunctive, but not always.
- **Examples:**
 - *Quizá Juan venga mañana.* (Perhaps Juan will come tomorrow.)

- *Quizá Juan fue el que dejó la puerta abierta.* (Perhaps Juan was the one who left the door open.)
- **Guideline:**
 - If the event is in the present or past, the subjunctive is optional.
 - If the event is in the future, use the subjunctive, future indicative, or conditional.

Conditional/Imperfect Subjunctive Combo:

- This combination is used to express hypothetical situations.
- **Examples:**
 - *Si fuera rico, me compraría un yate.* (If I were rich, I would buy a yacht.)
 - *Si fuera posible, me mudaría a México.* (If it were possible, I would move to Mexico.)

Pluperfect Subjunctive:

- **Example:**
 - *Si hubiera sabido que te comportarías así, no te habría invitado.* (If I had known you would behave like this, I wouldn't have invited you.)
- This is the subjunctive of *haber* followed by a past participle.

Using the Imperfect Subjunctive in Storytelling:

- **Example:**
 - *Juan me dijo que le llamara en cuanto tuviera la información.* (Juan told me to call him as soon as I had the information.)
- Use the imperfect subjunctive after subjunctive triggers when telling stories or recounting past events.

Conclusion

- Focus on using the -ra endings for the imperfect subjunctive.
- Remember to apply the same triggers you've learned for the present subjunctive.
- The next video will give you a chance to practice everything together.

Until then, *hasta luego!*